

2026

VEETE

CIMA TO
BRENTA

Access depends on weather not a map

the mountain is present

CLAUDIO GOBBER ART

claudiogobber.art

Preface

Vette originates from a simple observation.

Mountains are among the most enduring forms in our landscape. They appear permanent, immovable, **almost outside of time**. Yet our relationship with them is **constantly changing** through maps, regulations, tourism, protected areas, digital records, and human interpretation.

In this project, I begin with real mountains and real geographical information, but **I do not seek to represent them**. Instead, I observe what remains after layers of information, memory, and perception **are distilled**.

Each painting **starts from a specific summit**, yet gradually moves away from description. Elevations, boundaries, access rules, place names, and fragments of human language emerge and fade within the surface. **The mountain remains present**, but no longer as a landscape. **It becomes a trace**.

Through **reduction** rather than addition, Vette **explores the distance** between a place and our understanding of it. What appears fixed reveals itself as something continuously filtered through **observation** and **interpretation**.

As with all my work, **the objective is** not to explain the world, but **to distill a fragment of it**.

Vette is an attempt to observe what remains when the mountain is allowed to become memory, structure, and presence.

Vette does not ask what a mountain looks like.

It asks what remains after the need to describe it has disappeared.

Introduction

Vette explores the **relationship** between **place** and **perception**. Mountains are often regarded as symbols of permanence, stability, and endurance. Yet our understanding of them is constantly shaped by maps, borders, regulations, names, stories, memories, and personal experiences.

In an artistic context, **Vette investigates what remains when representation is gradually reduced to its essential elements**. Each work begins with a real mountain, but moves beyond traditional landscape painting. Through layers of marks, text fragments, geographical references, and abstraction, the paintings become less concerned with depicting a place and more concerned with revealing its presence.

"Photographs do not seem to be statements about the world so much as pieces of it."

John Szarkowski

In a cultural context, Vette reflects on the way we organize and interpret the natural world. **Mountains exist independently of us**, yet our relationship with them is mediated through systems of classification, protected areas, tourism, cartography, and language. The series questions how much of a place belongs to the landscape itself and how much belongs to the frameworks we build around it.

"The map is not the territory."

Alfred Korzybski

In a personal context, **Vette represents an exercise in observation and reduction**. Rather than adding information, the process seeks to remove it. The works emerge through a gradual distillation of form, allowing memory, structure, and presence to replace description. The mountain becomes less an object to depict and more a trace to contemplate.

In a time characterized by excess information, Vette proposes a different approach: **slowing down, observing carefully, and allowing meaning to emerge through reduction rather than accumulation**. The series invites the viewer to consider what remains when the need to explain, classify, and describe begins to fade.

Conceptual Explanation

Each work in “Vette” begins with a real mountain.

The starting point is not imagination, but **observation**. Maps, geographical data, protected areas, place names, elevations, and traces of human presence are collected and used as raw material for the process.

Rather than describing the mountain, the work gradually moves away from representation. Information is reduced, fragmented, layered, and distilled. **What remains is no longer a landscape in the traditional sense, but a visual residue of place.**

A mountain can be measured, mapped, classified, photographed, and named. Yet none of these things are the mountain itself. They are only different ways of approaching it.

The works in “Vette” emerge from this distance between the physical reality of a place and the systems we use to understand it.

The paintings do not attempt to capture the mountain.

They simply record what was left behind.

the mountain is present

Cimon Della Pala



Cima Tosa



Massiccio Adamello



Monte Civetta



Tre Cime



Monte Rosa





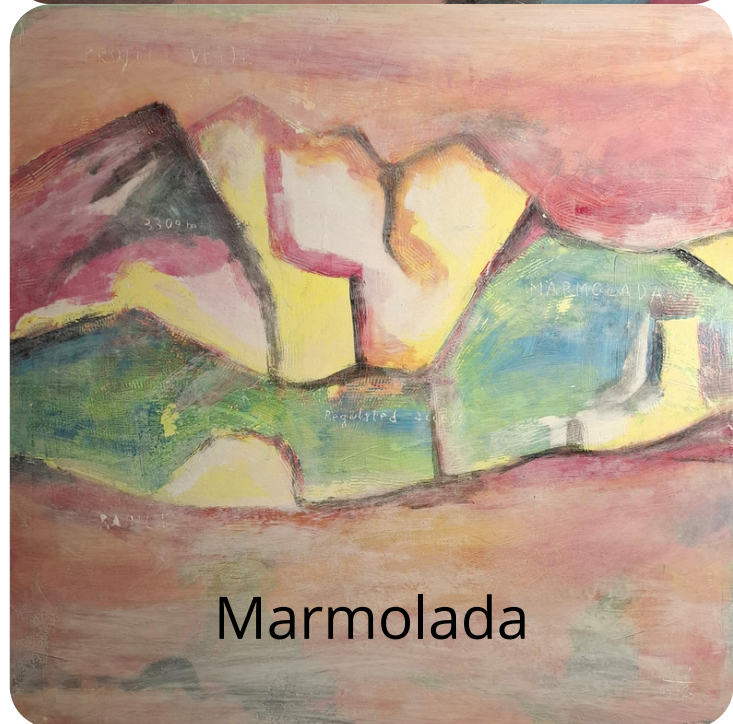
Gran Paradiso



Monte Bianco



Ortles



Marmolada



Etna



Stromboli

Closing Letter

When the Mountain Remains

For some, a mountain is a destination.
For others, it is a challenge to overcome, a summit to reach, a landscape to photograph, a memory to collect.

But for those who grow up beside it, the mountain is something else.
It is not an event.
It is a presence.

It stands beyond seasons, beyond generations, beyond the stories we tell about it. *Long before we arrive and long after we leave, it remains.*

Maps can describe it. Photographs can record it. Names can identify it. Yet none of these things are the mountain itself.
They are only traces.

The works in “Vette” begin with real places, real mountains, and real information. Yet through observation and reduction, they gradually move away from description and toward something more essential.

Not the image of the mountain.

Not its representation.

Only the traces that remain after the unnecessary has been removed.

Perhaps this is why mountains endure in our imagination.

Not because they ask to be understood.

But because they remind us that some things can simply be present.

And remain.

Biography



Born in Trentino, Italy, in 1979, Claudio Gobber grew up in the mountain valleys of Primiero and Vanoi. These landscapes continue to shape his way of observing the world and influence an artistic practice centered on attention, reduction, and presence.

Working across painting, sculpture, photography, and design, Gobber explores the traces left behind by contemporary life. His work investigates themes such as dignity, adaptation, memory, love, loss, and the relationship between people and the systems they create.

After earning a Bachelor's Degree and a Master's Degree in Advertising in Milan, he spent ten years living and working in London. During this period, he deepened his photographic practice, building upon the teachings of his grandfather while continuing to paint and sculpt in his mountain studio in Trentino.

Today, Gobber lives and works in Trentino. His artistic research combines traditional materials with contemporary tools and technologies, always guided by the same question: what remains after the unnecessary has been removed?

This approach led to the development of “Radice” (Root), a personal artistic framework based on observation and distillation. Through this lens, each project becomes an attempt to preserve a fragment of reality before it disappears beneath interpretation, noise, or time.

His mission is to distill the essence of our time. To ignite awareness. To inspire informed perspectives.

Gobber's works have been exhibited in national and international exhibitions and are held in private collections. He continues to explore new ways of observing, recording, and distilling the world around him.

Further Information

Description of the Works

The Vette series consists of twelve acrylic paintings on canvas, each inspired by a real mountain and developed through a process of observation, reduction, and distillation.

Every work begins with geographical information, maps, place names, protected areas, and traces of human interaction with the landscape. These elements are layered, fragmented, and progressively reduced until the mountain emerges not as a traditional landscape, but as a distilled visual presence.

The paintings combine acrylic pigments, graphic marks, textual fragments, and abstract forms to explore the relationship between territory, memory, and perception.

Rather than depicting mountains, the series investigates what remains after representation gives way to observation.

Together, the twelve works form a visual archive of places transformed through the act of distillation.

Series Details

Title: Vette

Year: 2026

Works: 12

Medium: Acrylic on canvas

Dimensions: 50 × 50 cm each

Artist

Claudio Gobber

claudiogobber.art

